PAPA 6014 Class Activity Guide

November 9, 2026 | 5:45–7:15 p.m. ET

Group membership will be announced in class. Find your group number below. Stay with the same group for both activities.

Editorial Board Activity

You are the editorial board of the *Blacksburg Journal of Public Administration*, a highly prestigious, though sadly fictitious, scholarly journal. Imagine we are reviewing Simon's 1946 article and an article drawn from Waldo's 1948 chapters 1–3 for republication in 2026.

Given what we know today, does each argument still hold up as an important and defensible contribution? Novelty is not the test. Ask what has held up, what needs revision, and what we have learned since.

Find Your Group's Question

Group	Role	Question to answer
1	Waldo support	Why does Waldo's argument still hold up today, given what we have learned since?
2	Waldo critique	What is the strongest criticism of Waldo's argument? What needs revision, stronger evidence, or an update in light of what we have learned since?
3	Simon support	Why does Simon's argument still hold up today, given what we have learned since?
4	Simon critique	What is the strongest criticism of Simon's argument? What needs revision, stronger evidence, or an update in light of what we have learned since?

Structure Your Three-Minute Statement

Choose one spokesperson. Prepare one statement containing:

1. **Claim:** Give your group's answer to its assigned question.
2. **Reading:** Use a specific passage to support your reasoning.
3. **Current example:** Show how the argument applies, or falls short, today, and what we have learned since.
4. **Objection:** Anticipate an objection to your position and respond to it.

Preparation: About six minutes to work.

Order: Waldo support, Waldo critique, vote; then Simon support, Simon critique, vote. Each spokesperson speaks once.

Voting and Discussion

After Waldo, **each person in Groups 3–4 votes**. After Simon, **each person in Groups 1–2 votes**. Cast your individual vote in chat and be ready to explain it:

- **A — Accept:** The argument still holds up and is strong enough as presented.
- **R — Revise and Resubmit:** Promising, with a specific improvement or update needed. Name one revision.
- **J — Reject:** The argument does not hold up well enough to be defensible or consequential today.

Discussion question: What evidence or revision would this argument need to hold up today?

Friedrich and Finer Restoration Case

Fictional case: A hurricane has left an island without power. Crews can restore only **one major corridor first**.

- **Plan A:** Restore rural hospitals, water facilities, and nearby communities first to protect vulnerable residents.
- **Plan B:** Restore the metropolitan port and supply corridor first to reach more residents and help move relief supplies across the island. Rural facilities would rely on backup generators where available.

Both plans are lawful and technically feasible. The governor has authority to set priorities but **has not decided**. You are career administrators advising the governor and he has asked for your advice.

Find Your Group's Argument

Group	Author	Plan to defend
1	Friedrich	Plan A
2	Finer	Plan A
3	Friedrich	Plan B
4	Finer	Plan B

What recommendation can you defend using your assigned author, and how should it inform the governor's decision?

Structure Your Three-Minute Report

Choose one spokesperson. Your report should:

1. Recommend your assigned plan and explain the reasoning through your author.
2. Use one idea or passage from the reading to support your argument in this case.
3. Identify and answer the strongest objection.

Explain who ultimately has authority to decide and what responsibilities administrators retain when giving advice.

Reports: Groups 1–4, three minutes each.

Discussion: What changes when different authors defend the same plan, or the same author supports different plans?